



PHOTO BY MILIND SHELTE

which have a long-term view of India's financial sector, as the most suitable partners. I believe getting high-quality, patient equity is crucial for sustainable growth. We are certainly seeing a policy shift in this di-

They are represented on our board by two nominees—one is the Head of India, and the other is the Head of Global Credit. They have already started attending our board meetings and will also

ROA (return on assets) by FY27. With the SMBC partnership, this journey could accelerate further, as we expect several positive synergies and new business opportunities to flow from the tie-up.

OUR CREDIT RATING IS EXPECTED TO IMPROVE FURTHER. ONCE WE SECURE THE NEXT RATING UPGRADE, MANY NEW BUSINESS OPPORTUNITIES WILL OPEN UP

rection, as reflected in some recent deals announced in the private banking space.



On the nature of the bank's engagement with SMBC

They are our single largest shareholder.

participate when we finalise our annual strategy. Given their investment, it's natural for them to be closely engaged with the management. Our strategy to grow the bank is a continuous process. We are already working towards achieving a 1%



On synergies and opportunities with SMBC

For the first time, we have an investor with a truly long-term view—someone who is willing to stay invested and give the bank time to grow. This is the first instance of

having such a patient, strategic partner. We have already started working with SMBC to identify how we can create value together. Currently, SMBC operates through five branches in India, including one at GIFT City, and serves nearly 1,000 large corporate clients. While they lend to these clients, they aren't able to fully meet all their banking needs—for example, cash management, transaction banking, trade finance and other services are often handled by other banks. I believe we can jointly work with these corporates to offer such services and generate fee-based income. These corporate clients are also supported by a large network of SMEs in their supply chains, which opens another opportunity. We can also finance these SMEs. In addition, there are individual employees of these corporates whom we can tap for both loans and deposits.



On whether companies will shift

Today, deals are no longer just about pricing—they're about solutions. If we provide the right solutions, customers are less sensitive to pricing.